VIT Bhopal University
VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

Digital Literacy Portfolio

Project Report — CSE0001

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Introduction

~~This report documents my work as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project a~~t VIT Bhopal University. Under the scenario of being selected as a Student Digital Ambassador, I was tasked with building a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio to help my peers navigate the modern digital world confidently and responsibly. The portfolio spans five interconnected modules: digital awareness, professional online presence, coding and collaboration platforms, professional communication, and cybercrime awareness.

Each of the five tasks in this project reflects a real-world skill that is increasingly essential for students entering the professional and academic domain. Through this project, I explored design tools, built my professional online profiles, practised coding challenges, drafted professional emails, and researched a critical cybercrime scenario. The experience has given me a structured foundation in digital literacy that I intend to build upon throughout my undergraduate journey and beyond.

Task 1 Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic Module 1 | 20 marks

Tool Used & Design Overview

For Task 1, I chose Canva as my design tool. Canva is a free, browser-based graphic design platform that offers hundreds of ready-made templates and an intuitive drag-and-drop interface, making it ideal for students with no prior design experience. I created a single-page infographic titled 'Be Digitally Literate – A Student's Quick Guide', targeted at first-year B.Tech students.

The infographic covers three core topics as required: (1) What Digital Literacy is — defined as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies; (2) Useful Digital Tools for Students — featuring platforms such as Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, and HackerRank; and (3) Safe Internet Practices — highlighting the importance of strong passwords, recognising phishing attempts, and being cautious about sharing personal information online.

Reflection

I found the experience of using Canva both engaging and slightly challenging. The most interesting aspect was discovering how much visual hierarchy and colour choice impact the clarity of information. The most difficult part was condensing each topic into short, readable callouts without losing meaning. I learned that effective infographic design requires prioritising key ideas and resisting the temptation to overload the viewer with text. This skill — communicating complex ideas visually — is something I will continue to

develop.

Task 2 Build Your Student Digital Portfolio Module 2 | 20 marks

PlatformsSetUp

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow. Each platform serves a distinct purpose in a student's professional digital identity.

GitHub

GitHub is the world's leading platform for version control and collaborative software development. I created my account and set up a profile README repository (named after my username), which includes my name, branch (CSE), current year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn — specifically, full-stack development and contributing to open-source projects. GitHub will serve as my coding portfolio and collaboration hub throughout my degree.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the premier professional networking platform used by employers, recruiters, and the academic community worldwide. I filled in my Education section with my current B.Tech degree in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University, along with my expected graduation year. LinkedIn will be essential when I begin applying for internships and building professional connections.

StackOverflow

Stack Overflow is the most widely used platform for asking and answering programming questions. Creating an account here gives me access to a massive knowledge base and allows me to participate in the global developer community. As I progress in my coding skills, I plan to actively answer questions and build my reputation on the platform.

Future Plans

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all my academic and personal projects, building a visible portfolio of work. On LinkedIn, I will gradually add internship experiences, certifications, and recommendations. Stack Overflow will be my first stop when I encounter technical problems, and I will work toward contributing answers as my expertise grows. Together, these three platforms form the foundation of my professional digital presence as a developer and engineer.

Task 3 *Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms* Module 3 | 20 marks

Part A – Coding Practice (HackerRank)

Forthecoding practice component,IchoseHackerRank. After creating my account, I completed the 'Solve Me First' beginner challenge, which involves writing a simple function to return the sum of two integers. I also attempted the 'Python: Introduction' challenge, which tests basic familiarity with Python syntax. Both challenges were completed successfully. HackerRank provides instant feedback and a visible score, which makes it motivating to practice regularly.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration (Google Forms)

Forthecollaborationcomponent,Icreateda Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for B.Tech First Years'. The form contains exactly five questions designed to test my batchmates' knowledge of digital literacy concepts:

- What does the term 'Digital Literacy' mean? (Multiple Choice)
- Which of the following is a safe internet practice? (Multiple Choice)
- Name one platform you would use to share and version-control your code. (Short Answer)
- What should you do if you receive an email asking for your bank password? (Multiple Choice)
- List two Do's for responsible social media use as a college student. (Short Answer)

The Google Form is linked to a Google Sheet that automatically collects and organises responses. This setup demonstrated how Google Workspace tools can be used collaboratively — the form can be shared with the entire batch and the responses analysed instantly.

Reflection

Exploring these platforms made me realise how important it is to be comfortable with a range of digital tools beyond just writing code. HackerRank will help me prepare for technical interviews through consistent daily practice. Google Forms and Sheets are tools I will regularly use for group projects, surveys, and data collection throughout my degree. These are practical, transferable skills that are expected in both academic and professional environments.

Task 4 *Professional Email & Etiquette Guide* Module 4 | 20 marks

Email 1 — Assignment Extension Request

Subject: RequestforExtensiononAssignmentSubmission – CSE0001 Digital Literacy

Dear Professor [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension on the submission deadline for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy Project Assignment, originally due on [original date].

Unfortunately, I have been experiencing [brief reason — e.g., a technical issue with my GitHub setup / unexpected illness] over the past few days, which has affected my ability to complete the remaining tasks to the standard I would like to maintain.
I would be grateful if you could consider granting an extension of 3–4 days. I assure you that I am committed to completing the work diligently and will submit as soon as possible within the extended period.

Thank you very much for your understanding and consideration.

Yours sincerely,
Charchit Jain
Reg. No.: [Registration Number]
B.Tech CSE, First Year — VIT Bhopal University
Email: [college email]

Email 2 — Internship Interest Expression

Subject:ApplicationforSummerInternshipOpportunity – Computer Science Student, VIT Bhopal

Dear [Name of Internship Coordinator],

I am writing to express my sincere interest in a summer internship opportunity at [Company Name]. I am currently a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University, with a strong foundation in programming and a keen interest in [relevant field — e.g., software development / data science].

I have been actively building my technical skills through online platforms such as HackerRank and GitHub, where I maintain a portfolio of personal and academic projects. I am eager to apply my knowledge in a professional setting, contribute to your team, and learn from the experience your organisation has to offer.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss how I might contribute to [Company Name] during the summer term. I have attached my resume and GitHub profile link for your reference. Please do not hesitate to contact me at your convenience.
Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,
Charchit Jain
B.Tech CSE, First Year — VIT Bhopal University
GitHub: github.com/[username] | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/[username]
Email: [college email]

Social Media Do's and Don'ts

DO's	*DON'Ts*
Keep your profile professional and accurate.	Don't share personal details like phone number or address p
Think before you post — consider how it reflects on y	Doon.'t post content under the influence of strong emo
Use privacy settings to control who sees your content	D.on't accept friend/connection requests from stranger
Give credit when sharing others' content or work	Don't spread unverified news or rumours online.
Report cyberbullying or abusive behaviour immediate	Dlyo.n't engage in arguments or offensive exchanges or
Use your college email for academic platform sign-up	Dso.n't reuse the same password across multiple platfo

Communication Scenario & Reflection

Awell-knownscenariowhere poor digital communication caused serious consequences involves a university student who posted a rant about their professor on a public social media account, using identifiable details. The post went viral among the student community, leading to a formal complaint, disciplinary action, and significant damage to the student's academic record and professional reputation. The professor also experienced undue stress, and the incident affected the entire classroom dynamic for the rest of the semester. What could have been done differently: the student could have communicated their concerns through a private, respectful email to the professor or raised the issue with a student counsellor. This task reinforced for me that every message we post online is permanent and public — and that professionalism in digital communication is as important as it is in person.

Task 5 *Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide*

Module 5 | 20 marks

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Cybercrime Type: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

What it is: UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud involves criminals tricking individuals into authorising money transfers or revealing sensitive payment credentials through deceptive tactics, resulting in financial loss.

How it typically happens (step-by-step):
1. The fraudster identifies a target — often a college student who has recently listed an item for sale on an online marketplace such as OLX. 2. The fraudster contacts the target posing as a genuine buyer and expresses immediate interest. 3. They send a QR code or UPI payment request, claiming the student needs to 'receive' the payment by scanning or accepting it — but the request is actually for the student to send money. 4. The student, unfamiliar with how payment requests work, scans the code and enters their UPI PIN, authorising the transfer of money out of their own account. 5. The fraudster receives the money and immediately blocks the victim on all channels.

Who is targeted: College students, first-time online sellers, elderly individuals, and anyone unfamiliar with the technical distinction between sending and receiving UPI payments.

Consequences: Immediate financial loss, often ranging from a few hundred to several thousand rupees. The victim may also suffer emotional distress, loss of trust in digital payments, and difficulty recovering the money since UPI transactions, once authorised, are typically irreversible. In some cases, victims are targeted repeatedly if their details are sold to other fraudsters.

Source: Based on incidents reported by the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and widely covered by Indian news outlets including The Hindu and NDTV Tech.

Stay Safe Online — Prevention Checklist

Thefollowingchecklistprovidesactionabletipsfor college students in India:

#	*Prevention Tip*
1	Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or bank password with anyone — no legitimate bank or payment app w
2	Remember: scanning a QR code or accepting a payment request means you are SENDING money, not
3	Use strong, unique passwords for every online account. Use a password manager app (e.g., Bitwarden)
4	Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all important accounts — email, banking apps, and social me
5	Never click on links in unsolicited emails or WhatsApp messages that claim to be from your bank, IRCT
6	Verify the identity of a buyer or seller before completing any online transaction. Use only official platfor
7	Do not download apps from unknown sources or grant unnecessary permissions (e.g., do not allow a to
8	Regularly check your bank statements and UPI transaction history for any unfamiliar transactions.
▪	[UPI Safety] Only use official UPI apps (PhonePe, Google Pay, BHIM) downloaded from the official Play
▪	[UPI Safety] Set a daily UPI transaction limit in your banking app to minimise potential losses in case o
▪	If you are a victim of cybercrime, report immediately at: cybercrime.gov.in and call the National Cyber

Reflection

The mostsurprising thing I discovered while researching this topic was how sophisticated and psychologically precise these scams are. Fraudsters are well aware that most first-time UPI users do not understand the difference between a payment request and a payment receipt — and they exploit this gap deliberately and efficiently. I also did not realise how frequently college students are targeted, particularly those selling items on second-hand marketplaces. One personal habit I will immediately change as a result of this research is that I will never scan any QR code or accept any UPI request unless I have verified the identity of the person on the other end through an independent channel (such as a phone call). Digital safety is not just about knowing the rules — it is about building habits that protect you even in moments of haste.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project has been one of the most practically valuable exercises of my first semester at VIT Bhopal. Across five tasks, I have built an infographic, established my professional online presence, explored coding and collaboration tools, practised professional communication, and researched a critical cybersecurity issue relevant to students in India today. Each task required a different skill set — visual design, self-presentation, technical practice, formal writing, and critical thinking — and together they form a holistic introduction to what it means to be digitally literate in the modern world. I now have a GitHub repository, a LinkedIn profile, and a working understanding of digital safety that I will carry with me throughout my career.

References

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- LinkedIn — Professional Networking Platform. https://linkedin.com
- Stack Overflow — Developer Q&A; Platform. https://stackoverflow.com
- HackerRank — Coding Practice Platform. https://hackerrank.com
- Google Forms — Survey & Quiz Tool. https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal, Government of India. https://cybercrime.gov.in
- National Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7).
- VIT Bhopal University — CSE0001 Digital Literacy Project Brief (2025–26).